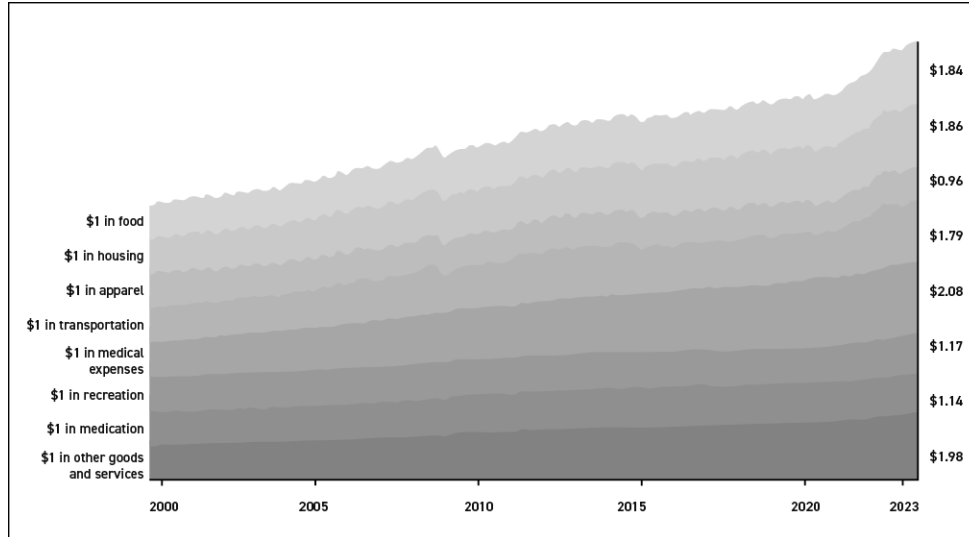


(innumerate), or purposefully misleading. There is nothing in between.

How far would \$1 from 1999 go today?



Take a look at the chart. It asks the question “How far would \$1 from 1999 go today?”¹⁶³

Same sort of foolishness, showing half of the ledger while ignoring the other half. If you want to compare how prices have risen for the things we buy, then you should also show people’s salaries used to buy those goods over the same period. Without it, you only see half of the spending equation. By itself, it is a big scary context-free number designed to frighten you.

The Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) tracks all of the individual prices shown in that chart, which runs from December 1999 to July 2023. The BLS also tracks wages, which have also risen over that period, from \$573 a week to \$1145. That’s a 275% gain, much greater than the various products’ price increases shown. And again, you buy goods today with 2025 dollars, not 1999 dollars.

What if that 1999 dollar was put into a simple investment like the S&P 500? It would have grown at an annual rate of 6.94% and be worth about \$5